

Project Charter Template

Agile Software Engineering Capstone

Use this charter during project initiation to agree on the project destination before detailed planning and implementation begin. The completed charter should show that the project is needed, feasible for the semester, and a responsible use of the team's available time and resources.

How to use this template: Text inside brackets tells you what to write. Replace every bracketed prompt with your team's information before submitting. Keep the charter concise. Put detailed requirements in the Requirements Document and detailed sprint scheduling in the Project Plan.

Document field	Team entry
Project title	Commerce Bank Personal Finance & Budgeting Assistant
Team name	Royal Development
Team members	Jake Hall, Cesar Giner, Jacob Melookaran, Joshua Webber
Project manager or team lead	Cesar Giner
Project sponsor	Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain
Customer or client	Commerce Bank
Instructor	Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain
Start and target end dates	September 04, 2026 - December 15, 2026
Version status and date	0.1 Initial Draft, September 25, 2026

Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Change and approval
0.1	September 25, 2026	Cesar Giner	Initial draft, Team Approval
[Version]	[Date]	[Name]	[What changed and who approved it]

1 Project Purpose and Authorization

1.1 Problem or opportunity

There are many people around the world who have trouble with their finances, especially in a time where being strict with money might be more important than ever. The time for people using cash to budget is over and everything has transitioned to a digital world which can be harder than some to adjust to. Only being able to see charged transaction amounts can lead to a loss of confidence and continued avalanche effect with no path to take. A clean, streamlined budget monitoring app with easy to use functionality could help a lot of people to get on the right track.

1.2 Project justification

Decision test	Team explanation	Evidence or source
Needed	Provides users a secure and accessible way to track personal budgets and spending by category with projected savings plans. Also included will be an easy-to-use AI assistant.	Commerce Bank Full Stack Finances and Budget Tracking Application
Feasible	We believe that this team has the well-rounded technical knowledge in front-end, back-end, databases, and generative AI to complete this project within the projected scope and requirements. We also have the help of the mentors of our sponsor who can fill the gaps in information we may have.	[Skills, technology, time, prototype, or available support]
Optimum	A budget tracking application allows the team to gain practical experience with a real-world company and employees while also furthering and developing our curriculum in computer science.	We would not usually have these same resources at our disposal if we were to try and attempt this project on our own or even as a group. The collaboration that we are privileged to will help us learn at the highest capability.

1.3 Product vision

Many banking customers struggle with tracking expenses, setting savings goals, and visualizing their spending habits. This application will act as a secure financial companion that integrates with their core banking institution to provide robust budgeting and financial goal tracking.

1.4 Authority to proceed

Authorization item	Entry
Decision	[Approved to proceed / Approved with conditions / Revision required / Not approved]
Conditions	[List any conditions that the team must satisfy]
Authority granted	[State what the team may begin, such as requirements work, prototyping, and Sprint 1 planning]

2 Stakeholders and Team Authority

Identify everyone who can affect the project or is affected by its outcome. Record their needs and decision authority so the team knows whom to consult.

2.1 Stakeholder register

Stakeholder or group	Interest needs or expectations	Decision or contribution	Contact or review cadence
Project sponsor	Successful, working full-stack capstone application that satisfies given requirements by Commerce Bank	Approves vision and/or implementation of product	Commerce Bank
Customer or client	Budget and Finance Tracking Bank Application that is fully developed	Provides feedback and acceptance input through mentorship and a semester check-in	Rebecca Fantasma Anar Agayev Julio Gracida Clayton Soniker
Target users	A budget tracking tool that is intuitive and usable regardless of technical background	Participate in informal usability feedback/testing sessions with team members	Will reach out to extended social network for quality and feedback
Instructor	Course requirements are met and demonstrate agile software engineering practice	Clarifies course scope and assesses work	Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain shs6g7@umsystem.edu
Student team	A distinction between responsibilities that need to be carried out on a realistic and achievable timeline	Builds, tests, documents, and demonstrates the usability of a Finance and Budget Tracker	imtgiv@umkc.edu cesarginer@gmail.com jwebb9024@gmail.com
[Other stakeholder]	[Needs and expectations]	[Decision or contribution]	[Contact or cadence]

2.2 Team roles and responsibilities

Team member	Primary role	Charter responsibility	Decision authority or backup
[Jake Hall]	[UI Design]	[Help team with UI]	[Decision area or backup person]
Cesar Giner	Front-End	Help team define project responsibilities	[Decision area or backup person]
Jacob	Back-end	[Responsibility]	[Decision area or backup person]
Joshua	[Role]	[Responsibility]	[Decision area or backup person]

2.3 Decision and escalation rules

Team will collaborate on project development issues and agree on routine decisions, if issue can't be resolved, we will consult with project sponsor.

3 Goals Objectives and High Level Features

Goals describe the desired direction. Objectives make the expected outcomes specific and measurable. Features identify the main functions that deliver value to the client or users.

3.1 Project goals

Goal ID	Goal statement	Why it matters
G-01	A fully developed finance and budget tracking application that aids users in their everyday life	Almost all of banking has transitioned to a digital medium pushing the need for an application that is closely integrated
G-02	[Describe another important outcome]	[Explain the value]
G-___	[Additional goal if needed]	[Value]

3.2 Measurable objectives

Objective ID	Specific measurable objective	Target date	How the team will verify it
OBJ-01	[State the result with a measurable target]	[Date or sprint]	[Demo, test result, metric, or approval]
OBJ-02	[State another measurable result]	[Date or sprint]	[Verification method]
OBJ-___	[Additional objective]	[Date or sprint]	[Verification method]

3.3 High level features

Feature ID	Client valued feature	Primary user or stakeholder	Priority
F-01	[Name the main capability without detailed requirements]	[User or stakeholder]	[Must / Should / Could]
F-02	[High level capability]	[User or stakeholder]	[Priority]
F-03	[High level capability]	[User or stakeholder]	[Priority]
F-___	[Additional feature]	[User or stakeholder]	[Priority]

4 Scope Priorities and Deliverables

4.1 Scope boundaries

In scope	Out of scope
[List the capabilities and work the team commits to deliver]	[List specific exclusions and work deferred beyond the semester]
[Include the selected financial workflow and required pages]	Real banking connections, real money movement, and real card data unless the sponsor explicitly changes the brief

4.2 Project priorities

Rank the priorities from 1 to 3. Use each rank once, then explain the tradeoff rule.

Priority area	Rank	Team agreement
Scope and product value	[1, 2, or 3]	[What must be protected or may be reduced]
Schedule and course deadlines	[1, 2, or 3]	[How fixed deadlines affect scope decisions]
Quality and technical standards	[1, 2, or 3]	[Minimum acceptable quality and testing]

4.3 Major deliverables and milestones

ID	Milestone or deliverable	Tangible evidence	Target date or sprint	Owner	Reviewer
M-01	Project charter approved	Approved charter	Sprint 0	[Name]	Instructor
M-02	Requirements baseline	Use cases, FRs, NFRs, and traceability	[Sprint 1]	[Name]	[Reviewer]
M-03	Architecture candidate reviewed	Architecture document and decision record	[Sprint 2]	[Name]	[Reviewer]
M-04	Midsemester increment	Working product increment and feedback notes	[Sprint 3]	[Name]	[Reviewer]
M-05	Feature complete	Testable release candidate	[Sprint 4]	[Name]	[Reviewer]
M-06	Final delivery	Application, tests, documents, and presentation	[Sprint 5]	[Name]	[Reviewer]

5 Resources Constraints and Assumptions

5.1 Preliminary resource and budget estimate

Estimate resources at a level appropriate for initiation. Student labor can be recorded in person-hours even when no money changes hands.

Resource	Estimated quantity or effort	Estimated cost	Source or availability	Owner
Student effort	[Total person-hours or hours per week]	\$0 course labor	[Team availability]	[Name]
Hosting or cloud services	[Plan and expected usage]	[\$ amount or free tier]	[Provider or course resource]	[Name]
Development tools	[Licenses or services]	[\$ amount or free]	[Source]	[Name]
Equipment or test devices	[Items needed]	[\$ amount or existing]	[Source]	[Name]
Other	[Resource]	[\$ amount]	[Source]	[Name]

5.2 Constraints

Constraint ID	Limit placed on the product or project	Source	Effect on the team
C-01	Complete the project within the course schedule	Course calendar	The team must adjust scope before missing a required deadline
C-02	Use only fabricated financial and card data	Sponsor brief	The product cannot connect to real accounts or process real money
C-03	[Technology, policy, security, or staffing limitation]	[Source]	[Effect]
C-___	[Additional constraint]	[Source]	[Effect]

5.3 Assumptions and dependencies

ID	Type	Statement	How the team will validate or respond	Owner	Review date
A-01	Assumption	[Condition outside the team's direct control that is currently believed to be true]	[How and when it will be checked]	[Name]	[Date]
D-01	Dependency	[Service, person, data, decision, or resource required]	[Fallback if it is unavailable]	[Name]	[Date]
[ID]	[Type]	[Statement]	[Validation or response]	[Name]	[Date]

6 Success Criteria Risks and Agile Working Agreement

6.1 Project success criteria

Criterion ID	What success means	Measure or threshold	Evidence	Reviewer
SC-01	[A user or sponsor outcome]	[Target value or pass condition]	[Demo, test, report, or approval]	[Name or role]
SC-02	[A product quality outcome]	[Target value or pass condition]	[Evidence]	[Reviewer]
SC-03	[A delivery or stakeholder outcome]	[Target value or pass condition]	[Evidence]	[Reviewer]

6.2 Initial risks and obstacles

Risk ID	Potential problem	Likelihood	Impact	First response	Owner
R-01	[Technical or nontechnical risk]	[Low / Medium / High]	[Low / Medium / High]	[Preventive or contingency action]	[Name]
R-02	[Risk]	[Rating]	[Rating]	[Response]	[Name]
R-03	[Risk]	[Rating]	[Rating]	[Response]	[Name]
R-___	[Additional risk]	[Rating]	[Rating]	[Response]	[Name]

6.3 Agile working agreement

Working practice	Team agreement
Sprint length and ceremonies	[Sprint length, planning, standup, review, and retrospective schedule]
Backlog ownership	[Who maintains priorities and how sponsor feedback enters the backlog]
Definition of done	[Minimum code review, testing, documentation, and acceptance conditions]
Communication and response time	[Primary channel, expected response time, and meeting attendance rule]
Scope change	[Who may approve a major change and how the charter and backlog will be updated]
Conflict or missed commitment	[Team resolution steps and escalation path]

7 Approval and Submission Check

Approval confirms that the reviewers understand the project purpose, boundaries, expected outcomes, and initial authority. It does not freeze the entire backlog. Record approved charter changes in the revision history.

7.1 Review decisions

Reviewer	Role	Decision	Conditions or comments	Date
[Name]	Project sponsor	[Approve / Revise]	[Conditions or comments]	[Date]
Shah, Syed Jawad Hussain	Instructor	[Approve / Revise]	[Conditions or comments]	[Date]
[Name]	Student project lead	[Accept team commitment]	[Comments]	[Date]

7.2 Signatures

Name and role	Signature	Date
[Project sponsor]		
[Instructor]		
[Student project lead]		
[Additional approver if required]		

7.3 Final submission checklist

- ☐ The problem or opportunity is clear and does not begin with a predetermined solution.
- ☐ The charter explains why the project is needed, feasible, and a responsible use of resources.
- ☐ Stakeholders, team responsibilities, and decision authority are clear.
- ☐ Goals, measurable objectives, and high level features agree with one another.
- ☐ In scope and out of scope boundaries can guide backlog decisions.
- ☐ Milestones name tangible deliverables, target dates, owners, and reviewers.
- ☐ Constraints, assumptions, dependencies, success criteria, and initial risks are recorded.
- ☐ The agile working agreement explains how the team will plan, review, test, communicate, and handle changes.
- ☐ Every bracketed prompt has been replaced or removed before submission.
- ☐ The version, date, author list, and approval decisions are current.

Recommended filename: TeamName_ProjectCharter_v1.0.docx